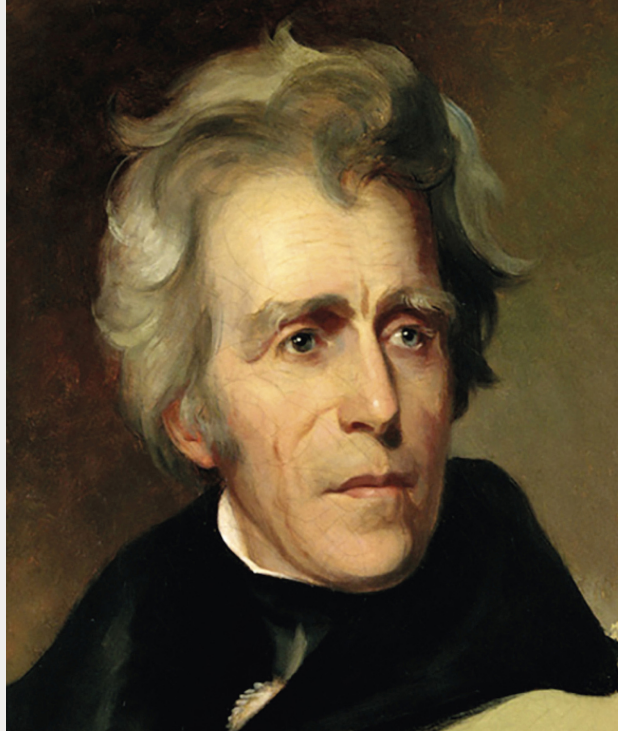




BEFORE

In the 1820s and 1830s, sectional divisions over slavery were always an issue, but never dominated politics in the way they would after the War with Mexico.



ANDREW JACKSON

THE NULLIFICATION CRISIS

Men like [President Andrew Jackson](#) were passionate supporters of the Union and strongly resisted the demands of individual states whenever they threatened national unity. One such moment was the [Nullification Crisis](#) of 1832 when, in an assertion of states' rights, South Carolina refused to implement the **import tariffs** imposed by the federal government.

SLAVERY AND THE WEST

As cotton production spread into the new lands of Alabama, Mississippi, Missouri, Arkansas, and Texas, the **soil of the Eastern states' plantations was becoming exhausted**. The expansion of cotton production meant the **spread of slavery to the West**.

Even before the War with Mexico ended, the debate about the future of slavery in the newly conquered territories divided Congress. In 1846, Pennsylvania Democratic Congressman David Wilmot introduced a proviso, or amendment, to an Army finance bill that would ban slavery from all territories acquired from Mexico. In the House, 52 out of 56 Northern Democrats and all